Thilo Klein CV

CONTACT

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Research Department 'Market Design'
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CURRENT POSITIONS

Pforzheim University
Professor (W2) of Quantitative Economics **2019 – date**

ZEW – Leibniz Centre for European Economic Research, Mannheim
Senior Researcher, Research Department 'Market Design' **2017 – date**
Head of Research Area 'Design of Matching Markets' **2017 – date**

MatchingTools GmbH, Mannheim
Co-Founder & Advisor **2026 – date**

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Heilbronn University
Professor (W2) for Quantitative Methods and Business Economics **2019 – 2019**

OECD – Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, Paris
Economist (A2/A3), Statistics Directorate **2014 – 2017**

ILO – International Labour Organization, Geneva
Carlo-Schmid-Fellow, Enterprises Department **2012 – 2013**

Bayer AG, Leverkusen
Trainee, Supply Chain Management **2002 – 2004**

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge, UK
Ph.D. in Business Economics **2010 – 2014**
M.Phil. in Management Science & Operations **2009 – 2010**

Friedrich-Schiller-University Jena
Diploma in Business Education & Mathematics **2004 – 2009**

PUBLICATIONS – Articles

Klein, T.; R. Aue; J. Ortega (2024). School Choice with Independent versus Consolidated Districts, *Games and Economic Behavior, 147: 170-205*.

Ortega, J.; T. Klein (2023). The Cost of Strategy-Proofness in School Choice, *Games and Economic Behavior, 141: 515-528*.

Reischmann, T.; T. Klein; S. Giegerich (2021). A Deferred Acceptance Mechanism for Decentralized, Fast and Fair Childcare Assignment, *Journal of Mechanism and Institution Design, 6(1): 59-100*.

– Discussion Papers

Freer, M.; T. Klein; J. Ortega (2026). Experimental School Choice with Parents, *arXiv*.

Klein, T; S. McNamara (2025). Sorting, Status, and Shadow Education: How Track Placement Shapes Parental Investment, *ZEW Discussion Paper #25-023*.

Bach, M; T. Klein; S. McNamara (2024). Access, Achievements, and Aspirations: The Impacts of School Tracking on Student Outcomes, *ZEW Discussion Paper #24-076*.

Klein, T. (2024). Matching for Credit: Identifying Information Asymmetries in Joint-Liability Lending, *ZEW Discussion Paper #24-070*.

Klein, T. (2023). Analysis of Stable Matchings in R: Package matchingMarkets, *Vignette to R package matchingMarkets (submitted)*.

Ortega, J.; T. Klein (2022). Improving Efficiency and Equality in School Choice, *ZEW Discussion Paper #22-046*.

Aue, R., T. Klein; J. Ortega (2020). What Happens when Separate and Unequal School Districts Merge?, *ZEW Discussion Paper #20-032*.

Klein, T. (2017). Intermediation in Peer-to-Peer Markets: Evidence from Auctions for Private Loans, *ZEW Discussion Paper #17-073*.

– Discussion Papers (cont'd)

Klein, T.; S. Verhulst (2017). Access to New Data Sources for Statistics: Business Models and Incentives for the Corporate Sector, *OECD Statistics Working Paper #17/01*.

Robin, N.; T. Klein; J. Jütting (2016). Public-Private Partnerships for Statistics. Lessons Learned, Future Steps, *OECD Development Co-operation Working Paper #27*.

– Policy Briefs

McNamara, S.; T. Klein (2025). Rethinking Tracking: Lessons from Hungary for German Education Reform, *ZEW Policy Brief Nr. 10, Oct 2025*.

Atayev, A.; G. Caspari; A. Hillenbrand; T. Klein (2023). Tapping into People's Impatience for Better Environmental Subsidies, *ZEW Policy Brief Nr. 4, May 2023*.

Klein, T.; M. Ott (2023). Mit Digitalisierung gegen Lebensmittelverschwendung, *ZEW Policy Brief Nr. 9, Juni 2023*.

Klein, T.; P. vom Baur (2019). Matching Practices for Teaching Positions in Public Schools in Germany, *Matching-in-Practice Country Profile # 28*.

Herzog, S.; T. Klein (2018). Matching Practices for Childcare in Germany, *Matching-in-Practice Country Profile # 26*.

Fugger, N.; T. Klein; T. Riehm (2017). Dezentrale Kitaplatzvergabe ohne Warteschlange: Ein Leitfaden, *ZEW Policy Brief Nr. 4, Oktober 2017*.

– Articles in German

McNamara, S.; T. Klein (2025). Frühe Leistungsdifferenzierung und ihre Konsequenzen: Lehren aus Ungarn für das dreigliedrige Schulsystem, *Wirtschaftsdienst – Zeitschrift für Wirtschaftspolitik, Heft 09/2025*.

Atayev, A.; G. Caspari; A. Hillenbrand; T. Klein (2025). Mit Ungeduld zu besseren Subventionen für umweltfreundliche Produkte, *Wirtschaftsdienst – Zeitschrift für Wirtschaftspolitik, Heft 06/2025*.

Steinberg, H.; S. Schüller; Y. Öztürk; T. Klein; Pia Schober (2024). Alleinerziehende in der Betreuungsplatzvergabe: Status quo und Handlungsempfehlungen, *Wirtschaftsdienst – Zeitschrift für Wirtschaftspolitik, Heft 05/2024*.

Klein, T.; M. Ott (2023). Effiziente und faire Verteilung von Lebensmittelspenden, *Wirtschaftsdienst – Zeitschrift für Wirtschaftspolitik, Heft 08/2023*.

Gretschko, V.; T. Klein; A. Wambach (2019). Die Regeln machen den Unterschied: Marktdesign, *Wirtschaftswissenschaftliches Studium, 48(4): 22-28*.

– Reports

Aue, R. et al. (2020). The Implication of School Admission Rules for Segregation and Educational Inequality. *ZEW Research Report.*

Badiee, S., J. Jütting and T. Klein (2017). The Role of National Statistical Systems in the Data Revolution, *Chapter 3: Development Co-operation Report, OECD Publishing*.

Badiee, S., T. Klein and E. Mohamedou (2017). Rethinking Donor Support for Statistical Capacity Development, *Chapter 4: Dev. Co-operation Report, OECD Publishing*.

Klein, T. and P. van de Ven (2017). Measuring the Value of Official Statistics, *Chapter 5: UNECE Report on Recommendations for Promoting, Measuring and Communicating the Value of Official Statistics, United Nations ECE*.

PARIS21 (2015-17). Partner Report on Support to Statistics, *OECD Publishing*.

Espey, J. et al. (2015). Data for Development: A Needs Assessment for SDG Monitoring and Statistical Capacity Development, *Technical Report, United Nations SDSN*.

– Books

Klein, T. (2012). Why Do India's Urban Poor Choose to Go Private? Health Policy Simulations in Slums of Hyderabad, *Ibidem Verlag: Stuttgart, ISBN 978-3-8382-0238-9*.

Klein, T. (2010). Microfinance 2.0: Group Formation & Repayment Performance in Online Lending Platforms, *Ibidem Verlag: Stuttgart, ISBN 978-3-8382-0118-4*.

– Software

R package `matchingMarkets`: Algorithms and estimators for matching markets

`Matching Tools API`: Application programming interface for matching algorithms

`KitaMatch`: Software documentation for childcare allocation

Refereeing

Programme Committee: *15th European Matching-in-Practice Workshop*, Mannheim 2018; *16th European Matching-in-Practice Workshop*, Gothenburg 2019; *17th European Matching-in-Practice Workshop*, 2021 Saint Petersburg

Journals: *Management Science*

Grants (selected)

MatchingTools: Matching Algorithms for Education and Labour Markets, Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy, €415.000 **2026 – 2027**

TafelConnect: Market design for food donations of producers, Federal Ministry of Food and Agriculture, €240.000 **2023 – 2026**

Tapping into people's impatience for better environmental subsidies, ZEW Sponsors' Association, €40.000 **2023 – 2024**

KitaMatch: Software for fast, fair and transparent daycare matching, Bertelsmann Foundation, €40.000 **2021 – 2023**

eco-Plattform: Market design for food donations of retailers, Federal Ministry of Food and Agriculture, €240.000 **2019 – 2023**

iLearn: Improving school admissions for diversity and better outcomes, Leibniz Association, €340.000 (joint with DIW Berlin) **2019 – 2023**

Design and impact of admissions rules for schools, ZEW, €330.000 **2019 – 2022**

Press coverage

Algorithms for matching markets

Frankfurter Rundschau 10/2023; Table.Media 10/2023; Süddeutsche Zeitung 09/2023; Tagesspiegel 08/2023; Zeit 08/2023; WirtschaftsWoche 12/2021; Zeit 02/2021; WirtschaftsWoche 01/2020; FAZ 11/2019; Rheinpfalz 10/2018; WDR 06/2018; Westfälische Nachrichten 03/2018; FAZ 06/2017

Market design for food donations

Mannheimer Morgen 08/2023 08/2023 08/2023; Mannheimer Morgen 07/2023; Süddeutsche Zeitung 07/2023; Zeit 07/2023; Welt 07/2023; Focus 07/2023; Stern 07/2023; WirtschaftsWoche 01/2020; Welt 06/2018

Others

School tracking: Süddeutsche Zeitung 03/2026; MDR Wissen 02/2026

Environmental subsidies: Mannheimer Morgen 06/2023

Conferences organised

Workshop on Algorithmic School Choice, Paderborn 2023; *Easter Workshop on School Choice*, Belfast 2022; *15th European Matching-in-Practice Workshop*, Mannheim 2018; *OECD-PARIS21 Big Data Workshop*, Paris 2015; *CJBS Doctoral Conference*, Cambridge 2011–2014.

Teaching (Selected)

Pforzheim University

Analysis and Linear Algebra; Statistics I+II; Econometrics I+II; Mathematical Optimization; Predictive Analytics; Risk Management **2019/20 – date**

Heilbronn University

Models of Data Assessment; Digital Economy; Academic Writing **2018/19**

University of Mannheim

Market Design: Auctions and Matching Algorithms (with V. Gretschko) **2018/19**

University of Tübingen

Microfinance (Credit, Savings & Insurance) **2013/14**

University of Cambridge

Game Theory; Econometrics I+II; Quantitative Methods I+II **2010/11 – 2014/15**